Boys don’t ~~cry.~~

Girls can’t ~~code.~~

Who taught us to finish these sentences?

KNOW ≠ BELIEVE ≠ ACT

Shourya Dixit · 2025115017 · THKS-2 Monsoon 2026

From a checklist to a language model

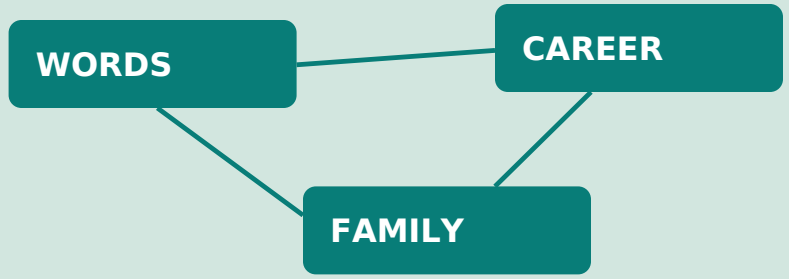
1933

People choose traits

- Group labels
- Shared descriptions
- Checklist responses

2017

A model learns associations



Conceptual diagram; not plotted model data

Different measurements. A recurring question about shared ideas.

Katz & Braly (1933); Caliskan, Bryson & Narayanan (2017)

How do stereotypes persist—and change?

How do they shape life chances? How do people respond?

1 **Learning**

2 **Institutions**

3 **Older media**

4 **Digital media**

5 **Open questions**

A thematic review across identities and settings, centred on the US and India.

Knowing is not the same as endorsing

Stereotype

Shared belief about a group

Prejudice

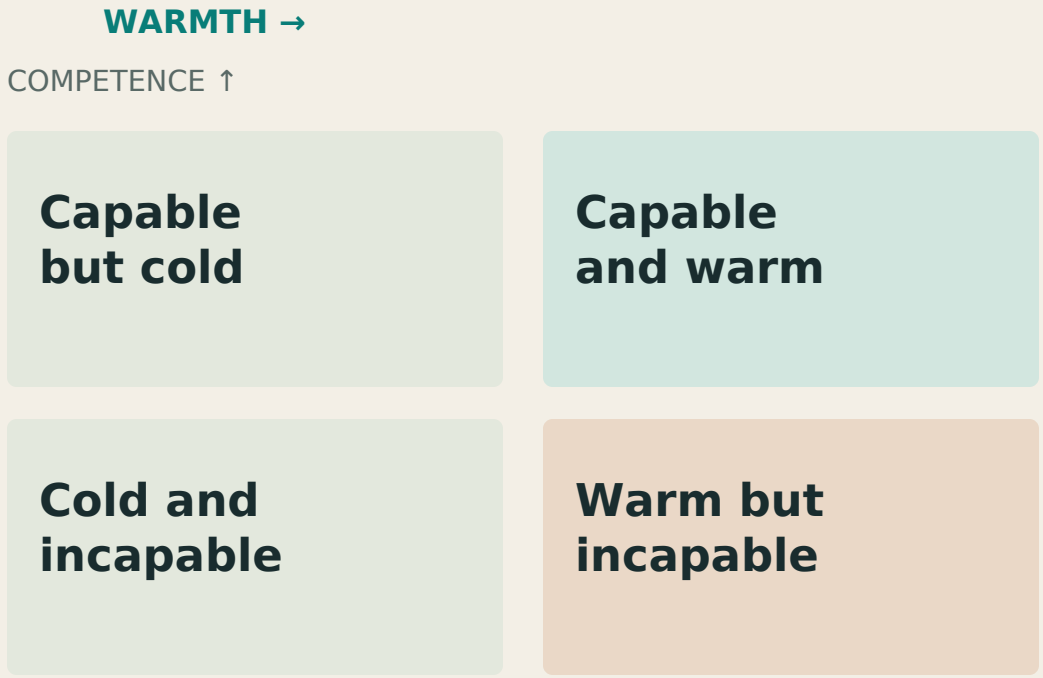
Negative evaluation of a group

Discrimination

Unequal treatment on group grounds

KNOW ≠ BELIEVE ≠ ACT

Even a flattering stereotype can restrict.



Perceived traits, not facts about groups.

Devine (1989); Fiske, Cuddy, Glick & Xu (2002)

What did the study actually measure?

Match every claim to the kind of evidence behind it.

METHOD	WHAT WE OBSERVE	WHAT IT DOES NOT ESTABLISH
Surveys / checklists	Descriptions of groups	Truth or subsequent action
Experiments	Judgments or task performance	Every real-world setting
Hiring audits	Employer responses	Motives, pay or promotion
Media content	Patterns in portrayal	Audience beliefs
Interviews	Accounts of lived experience	Population prevalence
Selected online posts	Public expression and dispute	What most people believe

The lesson starts early

6

YEARS OLD

Who gets to be “really, really smart”?

By age six, girls in these studies were less likely than boys to associate their own gender with brilliance.

Girls also showed less interest in games described as being for very smart children.

Early beliefs and interests were measured—not later career choices.

Bian, Leslie & Cimpian (2017); Ridgeway & Correll (2004)

A link is not a causal arrow

More television viewing

↔

ASSOCIATION

More traditional gender views

Family

Peers

Viewing choices

A small, consistent association. Direction and other influences still matter.

A decision before a meeting

Comparable qualifications. Different identity signals.

US / CALLBACKS

White-sounding names



≈150

Black-sounding names



100

Relative callback index; Black-sounding names = 100.

≈50% more callbacks

INDIA / MATCHED APPLICATIONS

Dalit and Muslim applicants received fewer positive responses than upper-caste Hindu applicants.

PARENTHOOD / ANOTHER SIGNAL

Mothers faced penalties.
Fathers did not face the same penalty.

Callbacks ≠ job offers. Related methods ≠ identical social histories.

Bertrand & Mullainathan (2004); Thorat & Attewell (2007); Correll, Benard & Paik (2007)

Who controls the test conditions?

US / EXPERIMENT

Ability-test framing

Black students performed worse under diagnostic framing in the original study.

INDIA / EXPERIMENT

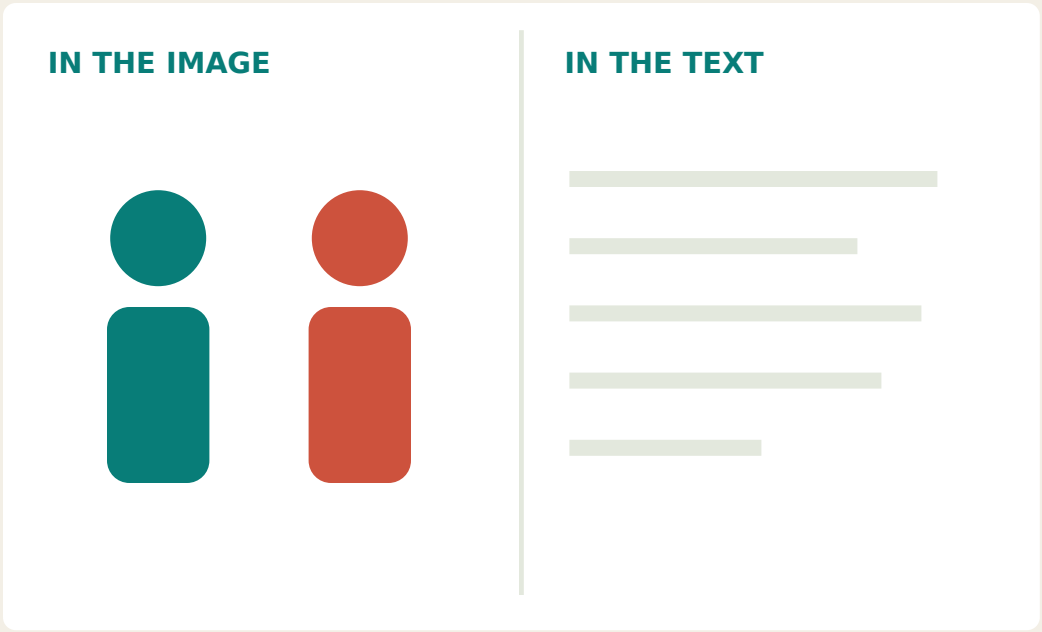
Caste made public

Making caste identity salient changed performance in a village task.

DISTANCING FROM A LABEL

People can reject “poor” for themselves and still blame “the poor”.

Visible in the picture. Missing from the story.



Conceptual illustration—not a reproduced book page.

01 Children’s books

Female characters appeared less often in text than in images.

02 Indian newspapers

Lower castes were strongly associated with victimisation and unrest.

03 Which women? Whose lives?

Intersectional invisibility complicates group-level visibility.

Adukia et al. (2023); Fonseca et al. (2019); Purdie-Vaughns & Eibach (2008)

Three ways a stereotype travels

01

Political amplification

SPRINGFIELD / 2024

A false anti-Haitian rumour moves through political accounts and memes.

02

Gendered humour

“GIRL MATH” / 2023

Self-directed humour and sexist readings can coexist.

03

Contested meaning

ILLUSTRATIVE PATTERN

One reply treats a caste joke as harmless; another challenges its hierarchy.

A post shows expression. It does not reveal everyone’s belief.

PolitiFact (2024); Demopoulos (2023); Ilbury (2022). Third panel is illustrative, not sampled evidence.

From being described to describing yourself

DISABILITY / OUCH

Control of the story

Disabled writers use humour, experience and varied interests to represent themselves.

CASTE / DIGITAL HISTORIES

Collective memory

Dalit users build histories and spaces for shared expression amid caste-based abuse.

Speaking ≠ being heard

Do not jump across the evidence gap

Different outcomes require different measurements.

01

Description

What is said?

Katz & Braly

02

Judgment

How is someone rated?

Fiske; Correll (lab)

03

Response

Who gets a callback?

Bertrand; Thorat

04

Life outcome

Hiring, pay, wellbeing?

Needs further evidence

Test performance is another outcome—not a measure of judgment.

Visibility, belief and fair treatment are distinct. Lasting change must be tested.

Katz & Braly (1933); Fiske et al. (2002); Correll et al. (2007); Paluck et al. (2021)

Four questions worth following

01 **RECEPTION**

What do audiences take away?

Track one event across news, television and posts.

02 **CORRECTION**

What do replies change?

Test belief correction separately from extra exposure.

03 **TREATMENT**

Does visibility change opportunity?

Follow creators and institutions over time, with consent.

04 **DURABILITY**

When does contact help?

Measure whether online attitude changes last.

Pettigrew & Tropp (2006); Paluck et al. (2021); Purdie-Vaughns & Eibach (2008)

Who gets to judge, and who has to live with the judgment?

KNOW ≠ BELIEVE ≠ ACT

Thank you. / Questions

A record changes the encounter

MATCHED APPLICANTS

Race × criminal record

A criminal record reduced positive employer responses in a matched-applicant hiring study.

BOUNDARY OF THE CLAIM

The design observes employer behaviour, not an employer’s private beliefs.

Caste descriptions and social distance

PATNA / QUESTIONNAIRE

Traits and association

Caste trait descriptions were associated with preferences for social association.

BOUNDARY OF THE CLAIM

A cross-sectional association is not longitudinal evidence of change.

When a stereotype becomes self-relevant

THEORY / REVIEW

Age stereotypes over time

The stereotype-embodiment account links absorbed age stereotypes to later self-perception and health.

BOUNDARY OF THE CLAIM

This article integrates prior evidence; it is not one new experiment.

A pandemic-era association

US / CROSS-SECTIONAL SURVEY

Social-media trust and threat

Greater trust in social-media information was associated with perceptions of Chinese people as a threat.

BOUNDARY OF THE CLAIM

A one-time survey cannot establish causal direction.

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